SERVERLESS COMPUTING: REDUCING INFRASTRUCTURE MANAGEMENT IN THE CLOUD

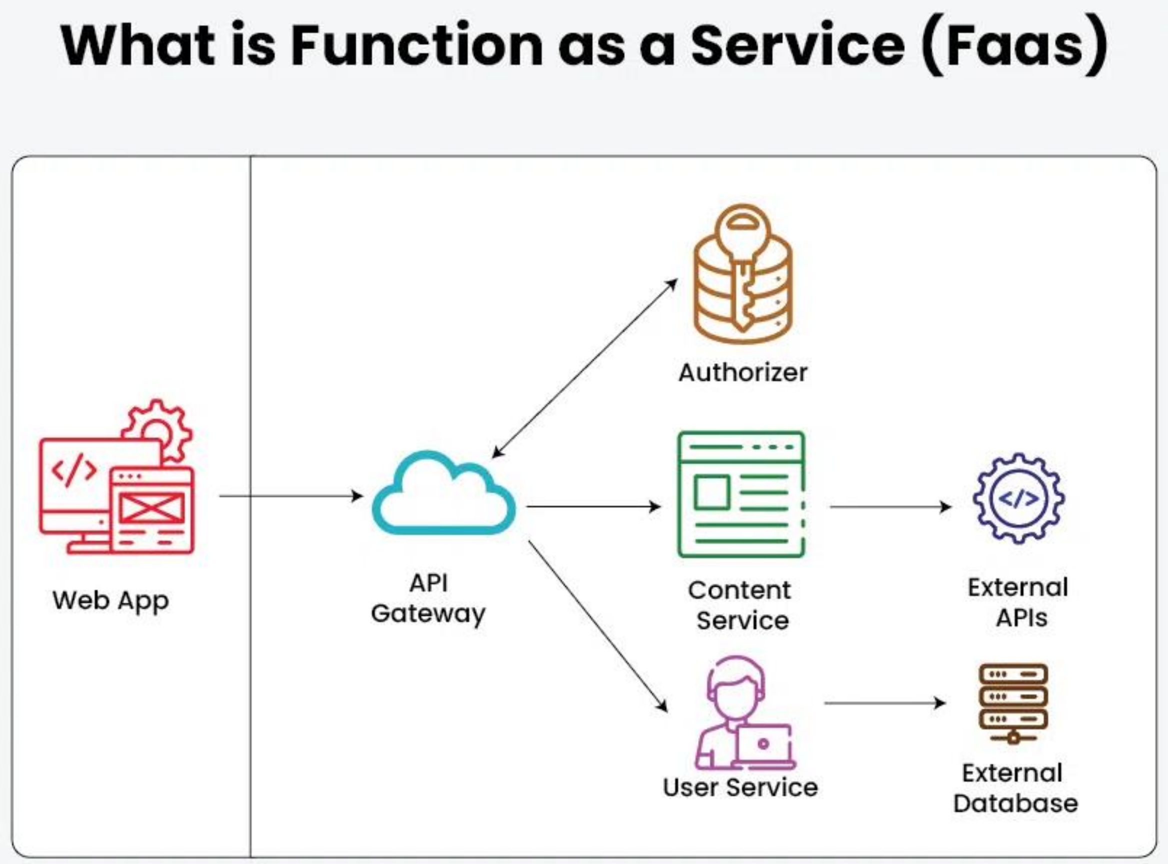
Supervised By:
Dr. C. Anuradha

Presented By:
Lochana Sri R.S. (192521348)
Kiruthikapriya S.(192521453)
Harsita Ashok (192521086)
T.Srija (192525223

Core of Serverless: FaaS

Function-as-a-Service

- FaaS is the central developer interface of serverless systems, shifting focusing purely to modular execution units.
- Developers deploy lightweight stateless functions triggered dynamically by webhooks, events, or messaging queues.
- The system guarantees automatic scale-to-zero capability when dormant, fully automating standard operational management.



The Serverless Workflow

1. End User

Client triggers an HTTP request, API call, or web upload action.

2. API Gateway

Routes request securely and handles rate limiting / auth.

3. FaaS Execution

On-demand runtime container boots and executes code function.

4. Storage / DB

Reads/Writes securely to serverless DynamoDB or S3 buckets.

5. Response

Instantaneous JSON reply routed to client, teardown complete.

Key Business Advantages

Zero Idle Cost

No active host server bills when idle. Only pay for execution time measured precisely to the millisecond.

Infinite Scalability

The platform inherently replicates runtimes from 1 to 100k instances automatically on traffic surges.

Faster Delivery

Eliminating system patching, OS upgrades, and VM configurations dramatically speeds up product ship times.

Practical Use Cases

REST APIs & Web Apps

Powering dynamic backends via simple API endpoints. Runtimes remain completely quiescent until queried by active clients.

Image & Media Processing

Triggering automatic resized optimization or video transcodes immediately upon file uploads to cloud object storage.

Chatbots & IoT Ingestion

Processing millions of brief sensor telemetry signals dynamically. Idle endpoints require zero pre-provisioned infrastructure.

Real-time Data Pipelines

Streaming data transformations, log parsing engines, and immediate ETL procedures executing asynchronously on incoming records.

Serverless Engineering Challenges

- **Cold Start Latency:**

  The inevitable micro-delay when a container instance spin-up occurs following period of inactivity.

- **Maximum Timeout Restrictions:**

  Most common serverless providers strictly limit process lifetimes (typically 15 minutes max per invocation).

- **Vendor Lock-In:**

  Code structures can easily become tightly bound to specialized proprietary APIs of individual vendors.

Serverless Platform Comparison

Specification	AWS Lambda	Azure Functions	Google Cloud Functions
Max Timeout	15 Minutes	10 Minutes (Cons. Plan)	60 Minutes (HTTP)
Native Runtimes	Node.js Python Java Go	C# Node.js Python Java	Node.js Python Go Java
Scaling Speed	Immediate, highly concurrent	Dynamic based on events	Rapid, near instantaneous
Free Tier Allowance	1 Million requests/mo	1 Million requests/mo	2 Million requests/mo

ENGINEER TO EXCEL

The Future of Cloud Development

Focus Shifts to Value

Developers construct customer features directly instead of managing operating system patches.

Maximized Resource Efficiency

Eliminates active cloud bill overhead when systems sit completely idle.

Serverless Ecosystem Growth

Expanding fast with serverless containers, databases, and message brokers globally.

Join the Shift

Serverless computing isn't just about deleting servers. It's about maximizing software velocity.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Supervised By:
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GPS Map Camera
Mevalurkuppam, Tamil Nadu, India
Ece Department, Mevalurkuppam, Tamil Nadu 602105, India
Lat 13.026284° Long 80.015996°
Thursday, 23/07/2026 10:23 AM GMT +05:30
University
சவீதா
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